

Closed, open source, open weight model

In closed model- you can only access it either through API or web. We cant modify it, retrain it or run it locally.

Example- GPT-4.1 / GPT-5 (OpenAI), Gemini 2.5 (Google), Claude 4 (Anthropic)

In open source models- everything is public. We can modify it, retrain it, run it locally and build our own version.

Example- DeepSeek-R1, OLMo (AI2), Pythia, BLOOM

In open weight model- An open weight model shares only the trained weights, not the complete model. We can run it locally, fine tune it but not build the original model exactly

Example- Llama 3.x (Meta), Mistral 7B, Gemma (Google), Qwen (Alibaba)

Features	Closed	Open weight	Open source
Use the model	yes	yes	yes
Downloading weights	no	yes	Yes
Run locally	no	yes	Yes
Fine tune	no	yes	Yes
View architecture	no	yes	Yes
Training dataset availability	no	no	Yes
Reproducing the original model	no	no	yes

If we want to study how the model was built, If we want to train from scratch, only open source

If we want to run locally on our hardware or fine tune a model for our own application- open weight model

Use the most capable AI through API- closed model